

Claim Migration Lab Teacher Notes

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 35-45 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	35-45 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	claim-migration-lab

Big idea: A claim can change meaning and justification when it migrates between knowledge contexts.

Overview

Students move one knowledge claim across several AOKs and watch how evidence standards and language must change.

Student Prompt

Inspect Claim Migration Lab Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Claim Migration Lab Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Claim: 'This pattern is meaningful' in mathematics, natural sciences, arts, and history. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Claim Migration Lab Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Claim: 'This explanation is reliable' in human sciences, history, and technology. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Claim Migration Lab Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Claim: 'This explanation is reliable' in human sciences, history, and technology. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — A claim can change meaning and justification when it migrates between knowledge contexts.

Actual Lesson Questions and Key

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Claim Migration Lab Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Claim Migration Lab Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
6	What changes when a claim moves between AOKs?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how a claim can change meaning and justification when it migrates between knowledge contexts.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Setup Checklist

- Choose claims with flexible wording so they can plausibly move between AOKs.
- Make students revise the claim, not just relabel the evidence.

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Claim: 'This pattern is meaningful' in mathematics, natural sciences, arts, and history.
- Claim: 'This explanation is reliable' in human sciences, history, and technology.

Suggested Timing

Stage	Teacher move	Watch for
1	Choose one broad claim and place it in one AOK context.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
2	Students identify what evidence would justify the claim there.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
3	Move the same wording to a second and third AOK context.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
4	Groups revise the claim so it fits each new context responsibly.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
5	Debrief why claims cannot always travel unchanged.	Assumptions, confidence shifts, evidence claims, and language choices.
Debrief	Move from the activity result to a TOK knowledge question.	Students distinguishing method, evidence, interpretation, and overclaiming.

Teacher Language

- The same sentence may not make the same knowledge claim in a new AOK.
- What has to change so the claim becomes responsible in this context?

Common Misconceptions

- Students may apply one AOK's standard of evidence to all knowledge claims.
- Students may equate certainty with value or usefulness.

Assessment Look-Fors

- Compares standards of evidence across at least two AOKs.
- Explains how a claim changes when method, context, or audience changes.

Differentiation and Adaptations

- Support: use two AOKs and one claim.
- Challenge: require students to identify a term that cannot migrate safely.

Extension Tasks

- Students use one TOK essay claim and migrate it across two AOKs.
- Build a class glossary of terms that shift across knowledge contexts.

Related Activities

- Method Swap Challenge
- Same Object, Different AOK
- What Counts as Evidence?